Iridescent

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Teen And Up Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra)

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by gloommistress

Summary

Half a year ago, Catra and their newly out best friend escaped their dead-end stifling hometown to move to the city, where they were each finally able to live as themselves.

Now, summer has rolled around, and Bightmoon is awash with rainbow flags and supportive messaging. Despite their reluctance, Catra is dragged along to the annual Pride festival by their friend.

Despite the loud noises, and suffocating crowds, Catra can't seem to find it in themself to be annoyed. Not when Adora is smiling as bright, or holding their hand as tight. Maybe someday soon they'll finally be able to confess how they feel.

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Written for the SPOP Creative Flex Summer SPOPtacular event! Prompt was "Showing your colors".

Notes

Adora is a trans woman in this, and Catra is a they/them lesbian.

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra was in hell. Bright, loud, crowded, rainbow themed hell.

People were pressed in on all sides around them, causing their fur to bristle and their claws to pinprick into where they were clutching at their arms. A nearby stall was blasting music at an absurd volume, and combined with the noise of the crowd, the cacophony was making shooting pains lance through Catra's mind, a migraine that showed no signs of abating.

They looked around frantically, searching through the sea of faces for someone, anyone, who was familiar. When they saw what they thought was a blonde ponytail bobbing in the crowd ahead of them, they began moving in that direction, as fast as they could through the tight packed streets.

They suddenly felt a hand on their shoulder, and spun around, a snarl at the ready. They schooled their reaction, however, when they saw the overeager expression of Adora behind them, holding something out to the Magicat.

"I went and got these for you!" Adora said in a raised voice, in an attempt to be heard over the elevated noise.

Catra eagerly snatched the earplugs from Adora's palm, hurriedly sticking them in their ears, breathing a sigh of relief when they blocked out the majority of the discordance surrounding them.

With the sound dampened, Catra could take a deep breath and relax. They took a moment to take in the blonde standing eagerly before them. Adora's face was painted with stripes of pink, white, and blue across her cheeks, and she was wearing a trans flag over her shoulders. She had her hair up in her eternal hair poof, and was dressed simply in a rainbow shirt with jean shorts, showing off her long legs. Despite sweat stains on her shirt, and wisps of hair sticking to her brow in the sweltering heat, she looked radiant. To Catra, she always looked radiant. It was one of the constants of their life. Water is wet, gravity pulls down, Adora is beautiful.

"Let's get out of the crowd," Adora said, and linked hands with Catra to guide them through the crowd. They found some steps of a nearby business to sit on, away from the bustle of people perusing the stalls and tents. "Sorry it's so crowded." Adora apologized. She knew how claustrophobic Catra could get.

"You don't need to apologize, Princess. I knew what I was getting into. Besides, it's not that bad with the earplugs." Catra returned.

"Other than that, have you been enjoying it so far?" Adora asked with a furrow of worry in her brow, as if it would be disastrous if Catra were having a bad time.

"It's … nice. Different." Catra replied after a moment. In truth, half the reason they had agreed to come along to Pride today was for the chance to spend time with Adora. These past few months, ever since Adora found those new friends of hers, it's felt like they were drifting apart, despite living together. They tried not to be jealous, but it was becoming increasingly difficult to not let their envy show. It seeped into every interaction with the blonde, discoloring and tainting what would otherwise be good memories.

So they had agreed to accompany the dork to Pride, despite their hatred of crowds, and loud noises, and the commercialization of the queer experience. If nothing else, it would be an excuse to get out of their small cramped studio apartment for a day.

Adora chuckled, eyes scanning the crowds of out and open queers before them, "Could you imagine anyone being this open about being gay or trans back in Horde?"

Catra couldn't help but laugh at the notion, "They would get run out of the town by a mob armed with pitchforks and torches, Weaver probably leading the charge."

Adora shuddered, "I'm glad we got out of there," Then her head turned to Catra, with a look in her eyes that Catra knew meant she was about to say something incredibly sappy, "Thank you for

coming with me to Brightmoon. I don't know what I would do without you."

Catra leaned their head against Adora's shoulder and sighed, "You don't have to thank me, dummy. Remember our promise? Where you go, I go. We'll always be together."

"Promise again?" Adora said, holding her pinky out.

Catra clasped it with their own, and said resolutely, "Pinky promise."

Adora alit into a wide smile, and rested her head against Catra's. For a long moment, the two just sat there in the shade, watching people mill about the festival. And for the first time in months, Catra felt contented.

Then Adora broke the silence, and all at once Catra's contentment shattered, "Oh! Glimmer and Bow should be here soon! I would love for you to meet them!"

Catra froze, conflict roiling inside them. In the three months since Adora had met her new friends, she had not once invited Catra along to meet them. Why now? And why on the one day Catra was supposed to have Adora to themself? Simultaneous parts irritation and hurt roared to life inside Catra, and they fought to not let it show on their face.

"Catra?" Adora asked, appearing concerned at her friends sudden penchant for silence.

"Yeah, yeah, that sounds good," Catra stammered out. Then moved to stand, holding out their hand to pull Adora up beside them.

"Cool! They're apparently over by the fountain, in the park." Adora once more linked hands with Catra, and began pulling them through the crowd to their destination. Soon enough they were approaching a pair of twenty-somethings that Catra could only assume were the illustrious Bow and Glimmer.

Glimmer had bright pink dyed hair, ashine with glitter and a purple shirt and blue leggings. Whereas Bow was wearing a tie-die crop top with a heart cut out on the chest, showing off his top surgery scars. They were both wearing pins with the bi flag emblazoned on them.

As they approached, both Glimmer and Bow wrapped Adora in a hug, while Catra stood off to the side awkwardly. When the trio finally parted, Bow was the first to address Catra.

"You must be Catra, we've heard so much about you! I'm Bow!" Bow held out his arms in the clear invitation of a hug, causing Catra to scoff.

"Sorry Arrow Boy, I don't do hugs." Glimmer frowned at the nickname for her friend.

Adora pouted, "You hug me all the time."

Catra shoved at her shoulder, "That's cause you give me those stupid puppy dog eyes if I say no."

Adora looked put out by the response, and then proceeded to give them those exact same puppy dog eyes. Catra merely rolled their eyes, not indulging the blonde.

"I'm Glimmer," The sparkly one said, and, wisely, held out her hand for Catra to shake. Catra did so and was surprised at her grip strength.

"Catra, they/them," Catra introduced, their tone disinterested.

"So what do you do, Catra?" Bow asked, as if he were actually interested. The gall of him to look so earnest.

Catra crossed their arms, "I bartend. You know the Crimson Wastes?"

"The lesbian bar?" Glimmer asked, one eyebrow raised. "I've been there with friends a couple times, surprised I haven't seen you."

"Maybe you just weren't paying enough attention." Catra returned.

"Not many Magicats in Brightmoon, I think I would have remembered you," Glimmer threw back. Catra could feel themself already growing perturbed at the wannabe princess.

"Well I'm there almost every night." Catra said defensively, "Not my fault if you're too blinded by all that glitter you wear to see me. Seriously, are you trying to poison yourself with microplastics?"

Glimmer was glaring now, "This is eco-friendly glitter, thank you very much. And for a bartender, you sure don't have the most friendly demeanor."

Adora was watching the auditory spar between the two with rapt attention, as if she were trying to gauge if introducing them had in fact been a wise decision.

"What's that supposed to mean, Sparkles?" Catra snapped, and Glimmer's eyes narrowed.

It was Glimmer's turn to cross her arms, "My names Glimmer, and all I meant was that you seem to be on edge."

"Yeah, well you haven't exactly been the most welcoming either, Glitter."

Bow interrupted then, with his hands up placatingly. "Guys, maybe we should just start over."

"Yeah, no." Catra turned to Adora, "I'm not dealing with this today." They turned and began walking away.

Adora grabbed their arm to stop them from leaving, "Catra wait!"

Catra wrenched their arm free, freezing Adora in place with a look, and sneered, "Have fun with your new friends, Princess."

Adora didn't stop them a second time.

As they marched through the park, Catra had to actively suppress the tears that were threatening to fall. They let their anger and indignation rise to the top, drowning out all the heartbreak over being replaced so easily.

Eventually, once they were sufficiently far away from Adora and her irritating new friends, they found a park bench to sit on, struggling to calm their breath from their worked up fervor.

Catra couldn't overcome the reality that was set before them in their mind. They were losing Adora. It was happening right in front of their eyes, plain to see, and they could do nothing about it. They always thought that even if they couldn't have Adora in the way they want her, at least she would always be their best friend, as long as they stuck together, like they promised.

But now even that remained unsure and nebulous. She seemed so happy and carefree when with Glimmer and Bow, relaxed in a way that she never was with Catra. Catra had seen it, stalking their instagram pages on nights spent alone in their apartment, when Adora was busy out getting drinks or partying without them, their bed cold and lonely without Adora's comforting presence.

Catra had known Adora their whole life, had watched her mature from a lanky self-conscious teen into a confident and gorgeous young woman. Had gone through hell with her, each escaping their own constricting home lives to carve out a new path on their own, just the two of them. And now she was leaving Catra behind, slowly but surely. And it broke their stupid heart.

"Wildcat!" A familiar voice shouted, causing Catra to look up from where they were succumbing to despair.

"Scorpia?" Catra stared incredulously at the platinum haired Scorpioni woman bounding towards them, trailed by someone they didn't recognize. Scorpia had been two grades higher than them back in Horde, and had left town after graduating to attend

college. They hadn't been that close with her overall, not nearly as close as they were with Adora, but close enough to miss her when she left.

"Oh gosh, it's so good to see you!" Scorpia wrapped Catra up in a crushing hug against their will. "How long has it been? Three, four years?"

"Five actually," Catra managed to get out through Scorpia's encompassing mass. At long last Scorpia put them down, and for the first time they noticed the pin on her lapel. "You're gay?" They blurted in surprise.

Scorpia rubbed the back of her neck sheepishly, "Um, yeah! Wasn't exactly safe to tell people back in Horde."

"No shit." Catra blurted, before recovering, "I mean, me too. And it's they/them, now."

"Thank you for telling me! Oh! Catra this is Entrapta, one of my friends from college. Entrapta, this is Catra, a friend from high school."

Entrapta briefly looked up from her phone, which she was rapidly typing away onto what looked like a spreadsheet, to wave hi.

"I like your pins," Catra complimented. She was wearing both an aromantic and asexual pin.

"Thank you!" Entrapta beamed, and then out of left field asked, "Can I record your behavior for one of my ongoing social experiments?"

Catra didn't know what that entailed, but answered anyway, "Um, sure?"

"Brilliant! I am learning so much about queer community and culture here! There's so much data to collect!"

Catra looked around at the multitudes of people walking by, all from different intersections of the queer experience. Drag kings and queens, butches and femmes, leather daddies and dykes, it was truly a metling pot of different lived experiences and identities.

"Yeah, it's really something," They remarked absentmindedly, before turning back to Scorpia, "Do you want to sit and catch up? It's been awhile."

"I would love that, Wildcat." Scorpia said earnestly.

Scorpia and Entrapta ended up sitting on the bench with them, and they exchanged light small talk for half an hour or so. Catra learned that Scorpia was now a fifth grade teacher, and had a fiance. In return Catra gave a brief overview of how they had gotten out of Horde, leaving out the more unsavory details.

"You really just left in the middle of the night?" Scorpia asked incredulous.

"Yup, took us three years to save up for an apartment in the city, since we couldn't afford college. Weaver, the bitch, started making us pay rent as soon as we turned 18." Catra explained.

"Oh wow! Well I am sure glad you made it out of there, Wildcat! Weaver was always a real piece of work."

"Yeah, you can say that again," Catra muttered, "Enough about me, where's this fiance of yours at?"

"She's off with some of her high school friends, we're planning on meeting up later! Oh I know! Would you want to walk around with me and 'Trapta for a while, and then you can meet her when we meet up!"

Catra chuckled, "Sure, Scorp, I'll hang with you guys. Not like I have anywhere better to be anymore."

Scorpia gave them an odd look at that, but didn't push the subject. Instead the three started perusing the stalls around the festival, talking to activists and grassroots organizers. Catra even signed up to volunteer at a local LGBT youth outreach program, with Scorpia's encouragement. Entrapta every so often would stop random people in their tracks, and bombard them with weirdly personal questions for her research. To Catra's surprise, the majority of subjects responded with eager openness, all too willing to answer Entrapta's stream of inquiries, to Entrapta's delight. Scorpia meanwhile insisted on picking up a piece of merch from each table, and soon was bedazzled with pride pins and flags and wristbands of every variety, like an oversized rainbow peacock. After a while, Catra found themself actually enjoying their time at the festival, and their worries about Adora treating them as an afterthought were pushed to the back of their mind.

"Oh the parade is going to be starting soon! We should meet up with Perfuma and her friends for it!" Scorpia exclaimed excitedly.

"Sure thing, lead the way." Catra gestured, and was immediately pulled through the crowd along with Entrapta. When they emerged into the small clearing the group had designated as a meeting place, they froze, stock still.

"You have got to be shitting me." Catra deadpanned, a glare already affixed on the group before them. Gathered there was a blonde woman Catra assumed was Perfuma, a blue haired woman, a mustachioed man, and the trio they had abandoned earlier.

"Oh, it's you." Glimmer threw back with disdain, causing Catra's fur to bristle. They were just about to respond with a verbal jab of their own when they noticed that Adora's eyes were red rimmed, and she was sniffling, as if she had been crying.

"You're Catra, I take it?" Perfurma asked sternly. Catra could only curtly nod at the sudden attention. Perfuma then grabbed Adora by the arm, and then Catra, and then began marching them away from the group at large, declaring, "We'll be right back."

Catra let themself be pulled along, in awe at the blonde's audacity. Perfuma placed them in front of a nearby bench, and ordered, "Sit."

They both did, if for no other reason than to not make things even more awkward.

Perfuma placed her hands on her hips, and stated definitively, "Here's whats going to happen. I'm going to leave to give you some privacy, and then the two of you are going to talk through exactly what has led to this. Am I understood?"

Catra and Adora both nodded, each at a loss for words. After Perfuma turned and left, they both sat there in silence for a long moment. Determined not to break first, Catra raised a single eyebrow at the dork before them.

"What?" Adora asked, confused.

"What do you mean, what? Aren't you going to apologize?" Catra said haughtily.

"Apologize for what! You're the one who left me!" She exclaimed, affronted.

Catra huffed, "What, so you just get to avoid me for three months and its supposed to be fine, but when I get some space suddenly I'm the bad guy?!"

"What--, I have not been avoiding you! How would I even avoid you?! We live together!"

"Well that's what it's sure felt like! When was the last time we spent any time together outside of sleeping in the same room?"

Adora's jaw hinged up and down soundlessly, before stammering, "It's not like that, I swear!"

"Then what is it like?" Catra demanded. "Cause I can't come up with any other reasons why you would just abandon me like that!

Am I really that intolerable? That as soon as you find someone remotely bearable you instantly drop me by the wayside?"

When Adora didn't say anything, just looked at them in shock, Catra scoffed and made to stand, "Whatever, I'm going home."

"I have feelings for you!" Adora blurted, leaving Catra stunned silent in place, "Romantic ones, I mean. I only figured it out three months ago, when I met Bow and Glimmer. Talking with them really put things into perspective. I've never felt like anyone else, the way I feel about you, and it terrified me. And I know you don't feel the same way, can't feel the same way, and that's fine! I'm not asking you to! But I was terrified of losing what we had, so I maybe kinda spent all my time with Bow and Glimmer instead? And now, looking back, I can see how stupid that all sounds, but please, you just have to know it wasn't you. It wasn't ever you. I'm so, so sorry, and please forgive me?" Adora finished her monologue in an upward lilt, while Catra gaped in disbelief.

As thoughts raced through their head, one question rose to the top. "Why can't I feel the same way, Adora?" They asked quietly.

Adora's shoulders slumped in shame, and she said, "Cause you're you, and I'm … me."

Catra tilted their head, "What does that mean?"

"Catra, you're a lesbian. And I'm …" Adora merely gestured to her body, and her eyes became downcast.

"Hey, hey, look at me," Catra tilted Adora's chin up to meet their eyeline, "You're a woman, Adora. A beautiful, strong, gorgeous woman. And I would be lucky to have you."

Adora was blushing now, a deep mauve that spread down her cheeks and shoulders, coloring her pale skin. "You already do. Have me, I mean." She said sheepishly. "You always have. That is, if you want me?"

In lieu of answering, Catra darted their head forward, capturing Adora's lips in a timid kiss, causing her to release an adorable "Mrp!". It took a moment, but eventually Adora got with the program and kissed them back, deepening and lengthening the kiss, meeting them with fervor.

They stayed like that for several minutes, enjoying the taste of each other's mouths. Catra only pulled back when Adora's hands began absently wandering, clutching at their waste and pulling them close.

"Slow down there, Princess, we're in public." Catra lightly chastised.

"Sorry," Adora apologized, with no hint of remorse on her face. Instead, she was grinning wildly. "So, does this mean we're good?"

Despite themself, Catra laughed, "Yes, dummy, we're good. And for the record, I feel the same way."

"You do?" Adora asked breathless, with those adorable puppy dog eyes trained on them.

"I do," Catra said more earnestly, pecking at Adora's lips once more. "Now c'mon, everyone's probably waiting for us."

"I thought you didn't like my friends?"

Catra hummed in happiness, "I can tolerate them, if it means I can have you."

Adora beamed, before her eyes furrowed once more, "What do I call you now? Like what are you to me now?"

"Hmmm, how about your partner. On one condition though."

"Name it." Adora said with determination.

"I get to call you my girlfriend." Catra said slyly, taking Adora's hand.

"I would love that." Adora's smile was infectious.

"Good, cause you better get used to it." Catra smirked, overbrimming with joy.

Hand in hand, Catra led Adora back to the group at large, where the parade was just beginning to march past. They didn't let go of Adora's hand the rest of the night, not until they were snuggled up in their bed, Adora resting on their chest, falling into a deep, peaceful sleep.

End Notes

You can pry my ace/aro Entrapta headcanon from my cold dead hands. I think she's in a queerplatonic relationship with Hordak, and I will stand by that.
Also yes, Catra and Adora were sharing a bed even before confessing to each other. My thoughts are that they couldn’t afford anything but a studio apartment, and only bought one bed to save money. Totally 'just friends' behavior lol.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!